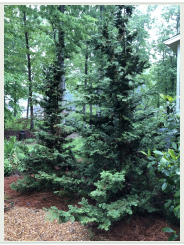
Hinoki Cypress, Hinoki Falsecypress

Chamaecyparis obtusa

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Water Terrace: 3 **TOTAL 3**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available

Not available

Leaf close-up
Not available

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Evergreen
Mature size: 50–75 ft in cultivation (to 120 ft in native habitat).
Confirmed by Missouri Botanical Garden (50–75 ft), Morton Arboretum (50–75 ft). × 10–25 ft. Confirmed.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Hardy Zones 4–8. Suitable for Zone 8a. Performs in southern landscapes with afternoon shade and consistent moisture. Prefers humid conditions. Not stated for specific Atlanta trials beyond general hardiness. Restart pass (2026-10-13): NC State confirms full sun to part shade, well-drained moist soils, drought tolerant once established. [https://plants.ces.ncsu.edu/plants/chamaecyparis-obtusa/]
Sun: Full sun to part shade. Best in full sun.
Water: Medium. Prefers moist, well-drained soil. Moderate drought tolerance once established.
Soil: Moist, fertile, slightly acidic, well-drained preferred. Avoid wet soils.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun to part shade in moist, well-drained, slightly acidic soil. Shelter from strong winds. Water until established. Suitable for screens or specimens in Atlanta.
Soil prep: Moist, fertile, slightly acidic, well-drained preferred. Avoid wet soils.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Japan and Taiwan.
Form / habit: Evergreen. Pyramidal with horizontal branching and drooping tips. Moderate growth. Many dwarf cultivars exist.
Foliage: None (evergreen). Inner foliage may brown naturally in fall.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Reddish-brown, peeling in strips on mature trees.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Possible root rot in wet soils, bagworms, tip blights. Generally few serious problems when well-drained. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a incidence not stated.
Not stated
Additional:
- Scale-like dark green foliage with white markings below. - Aromatic when crushed. - Extremely variable in cultivars (dwarfs to full size).